

Configuring updates of dynamic host agents

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The dynamic host agents in Instana automatically update to new versions of bundles, such as agent, sensors, and discoveries. You can control this updates as you require, by setting a preferred update schedule, by pinning a version, or by disabling the updates altogether.

Note: The automatic updates apply only to Instana dynamic host agents. If you use a static host agent, you must manually update the agent by installing the required host agent packages. You can use technologies such as Ansible or Terraform to perform the update. For more information on the difference between static and dynamic agents, see [Host agent types](#).

Attention

The automatic updates of the dynamic host agents update only the [agent bundles](#). To update the [agent bootstrap](#), you must reinstall the agent manually. You are suggested to periodically reinstall the agent to make sure that you get the necessary bootstrap changes. See the [Planned updates to the agent](#) section plan your manual updates to avoid risks.

Setting agent version update controls [🔗](#)

Dynamic agents check for new versions every day between 4:15 AM and 4:45 AM by default. You can schedule this automatic check to run at a specific frequency, time, and days. You can also disable it if you do not want the agent to check for updates. Additionally, the agents run their version check and updates randomly over a specified period to avoid congesting the network with synchronized requests. You can modify this period by using the `jitter` setting and set the time range in which the agent restarts.

Note: Scheduled updates are not suggested for production environments that run critical workloads. If you select this approach, make sure to run the scheduled updates during a maintenance window and then restart the workloads.

You can also configure the agent to use a specific pinned version to minimize the risks in the production environment during the agent updates. This approach ensures full control over version updates. By

using a pinned agent version update strategy, you can keep the agent's capability to update itself at a specific time without manually reinstalling the agent. This approach is suggested for critical production environments.

The processes to control the agent updates and pin versions depend on whether the agent is deployed on a [host](#) or a [containerized environment](#).

Note: If you run multiple agents that are deployed across different environments and require a centralized version control, see [Controlling agent updates with Git](#).

Note: Notes: Disabling automatic updates is not suggested. If you disable the automatic updates, the agent still updates to the latest version when it is restarted. In Kubernetes and Red Hat OpenShift environments, every pod restart pulls the latest agent version. You are suggested to avoid pinning agent versions for longer than 6 months to ensure access to the latest updates and fixes.

Control updates in host agents [🔗](#)

To schedule the automatic check in host agent deployments, open the `etc/instana/com.instana.agent.main.config.UpdateManager.cfg` file and modify the settings as required. See the following example:

```
# Instana Update Manager configuration.
# AUTO for automatic updates with given schedule. OFF for no automatic updates.
mode = AUTO
# DAY for daily, MONDAY, TUESDAY, WEDNESDAY, THURSDAY, FRIDAY, SATURDAY, SUNDAY
every = DAY
# Time is hh:mm in 24 hours format.
at = 04:30
# Spread updates randomized over 30 minutes around the configured time
jitter = 30
```

To pin a version for the agent and stop all future updates, open the `*instanaAgentDir*/etc/instana/com.instana.agent.bootstrap.AgentBootstrap.cfg` file before startup and add the following configuration:

```
version = <sha or tag>
```

where sha is the SHA value of the agent version commit in the [Agent Updates](#) Git repository, and tag is the release identifier of the agent version as given in the [Agent Updates - tags](#) page.

Control updates in containerized agents [↗](#)

To schedule the automatic check in host agent deployments, you must use the following environment variables:

- `INSTANA_AGENT_UPDATES_FREQUENCY`: Specifies the frequency of version check and update. Valid values are DAY (for daily updates), MONDAY, TUESDAY, WEDNESDAY, THURSDAY, FRIDAY, SATURDAY or SUNDAY. You can add multiple options separated by a colon.
- `INSTANA_AGENT_UPDATES_TIME`: Specifies the time at which the version check and update is run.

To pin a version for the agent and stop all future updates, use the `INSTANA_AGENT_UPDATES_VERSION` environment variable and specify the SHA value of the agent version commit in the [Agent Updates](#) Git repository.

For more information on these environment variables, see [Environment variables for host agent](#).

To configure the environment variables, use either of the following methods:

- Save your environment variable configurations under `spec.agent.env` in the agent custom resource file `instana-agent.customresource.yaml` and apply the changes by running the following command:

```
kubectl apply -f instana-agent.customresource.yaml
```



- Specify the configuration on the command line directly by using the flag `--set agent.env.<ENVIRONMENT_VARIABLE>=<value>`.

Retrieving the current version [↗](#)

The following host agent API endpoint provides the version of the host agent's components:

```
curl localhost:42699/version
```

